the economic reforms, even as other, more reform-minded, leaders remained opposed.

In 1994, for example, the Confederation of Indian Industries, regarded as one of the most pro-reform voices in Indian business, stunned pro-liberalisation advocates in corporate India by taking a position that would have sounded like ‘chamber music’ to the ears of pro-swadeshi businesses. In a seven-page document titled *MNCs: India Strategy Needs Rethink*, it virtually signalled a ‘revolt against foreign investment’, accusing foreign firms of betraying their Indian partners in joint ventures by selling antiquated technology and duping Indian customers.[79] This was very similar to the kind of concerns the BJP had also been raising in its policy statements on economic reforms. At a time when the party needed political alliances to consolidate its gains, espousing these concerns on reforms also opened up the possibility of alliances with other Opposition leaders who had protectionist leanings and a socialist lineage, such as George Fernandes and Ramakrishna Hegde, both of whom entered into alliances with the BJP.

In the 1990s, the party specifically positioned its economics in opposition to the Manmohan Singh–Narasimha Rao model. It argued for a simultaneous focus on the domestic swadeshi industry and for caution on the impact of foreign investments, even as it supported the opening up of the economy. Jay Dubashi, one of the architects of its New Economic Policy, summed up this approach: ‘BJP’s economic philosophy stands on three pillars: economic development or growth; social stability or harmony; and self-reliance or swadeshi. In fact, the best way to remember the word *swadesh*, in which *swa* stands for *swalamban* or swadeshi for self-reliance, *de* stands for development and *sh* for social harmony.’ This model was in contrast to what the BJP saw as the three pillars of what it called the ‘IMF–Manmohan Singh model’: (i) fiscal stabilisation, (ii) restructuring and (iii) foreign investment. The BJP’s big fear was that India would fall into debt traps, like Mexico, Brazil or the Soviets had.[80] The party did not have a problem with the first two tenets of the Rao–Singh outlook, but saw foreign investment as ‘the most dangerous element in the new policy’. It was ‘totally opposed to the Rao government’s approach’ to foreign investment. As the BJP saw it, Manmohan